

GUARDIAN LAYER · PRE-DEVELOPMENT DESIGN AUDIT

Guardian Audit — TM Operations Dashboard (TMS)

A single-screen command-centre for a transportation manager at shift start: a 7-button toolbar, a 6-tile KPI bar, a live route map, a real-time exceptions feed with inline Approve / Dismiss, a carrier performance table with sparklines, and a 30-day cost-trend chart — all on screen at once, with no calm state.

AUDIT RUN	PILLAR	PAGE TYPE	AGENTS RUN
2026-06-29T09:48:00Z	TMS — Transportation Mgmt	Complex · 5-zone dashboard	6 (2 specced · 4 stub)



OVERALL GUARDIAN DECISION
Blocked — Send Back

7 LOAD-BEARING FAILS **17** ADVISORY FAILS + WARNS **10** CRITERIA PASSED



Step 1 — Derived design spec

Interactive elements above fold	~20+ — 7 toolbar buttons + 6 KPI tiles + map panel + exceptions feed (with 2 inline actions per row) all render simultaneously. Far exceeds the ≤ 6 threshold.
Actions — default state	7 persistent toolbar actions (New Shipment, Approve All, Export, Filter, Sort, View Report, Configure) — all weighted as primary.
Actions — exception-selected state	Inline "Approve reroute" + "Dismiss" appear alongside the 7 persistent toolbar actions; no single primary action dominates.
Persistent decorative elements	Per-KPI delta arrows + mini sparklines, animated carrier pins that pulse on delay, and a "live" label that flashes on a 60-second refresh. None drives a decision.
Calm / empty state	None — "the dashboard always shows all data". No instructional empty state exists.
Ambiguities affecting the audit	Pulse rate of the carrier pins is unspecified (relevant to A4 Three Flashes); the real-time feed's refresh behaviour while an Approve/Dismiss is in progress is unspecified (relevant to A3 Timing Adjustable). Both are flagged rather than assumed.

**FAIL****H1. Nielsen #8 — Aesthetic & minimalist design**

LB

~20+ interactive + content elements render above the fold (toolbar, 6 KPI tiles, map, feed); grossly exceeds the ≤ 6 threshold.

FAIL**H2. Hick's Law — actionable choices at any state**

LB

The persistent toolbar exposes 7 primary actions before any per-row Approve/Dismiss; more than double the ≤ 3 threshold and a heavy decision-time penalty.

FAIL**H3. Miller's 7 $\pm$ 2 — distinct information chunks**

LB

Toolbar + 6 KPI tiles + map + exceptions feed + carrier table + cost chart = 11+ distinct chunks competing at once; over the ≤ 7 threshold and past the 9-item WARN boundary.

FAIL**H4. Cognitive Load — no extraneous elements**

LB

KPI delta arrows, mini sparklines, pulsing map pins, and the flashing "live" label add persistent visual noise with zero decision value.

FAIL**H5. Information scent — calm state has one primary focus**

LB

There is no calm state; five zones compete permanently for first fixation, so the gaze never lands on a single primary focus.

FAIL**H6. Information scent — busy state has exactly one primary action**

LB

When an exception is selected, inline Approve/Dismiss share weight with 7 persistent toolbar actions; no single primary action is identifiable.

WARN**H7. F-pattern alignment (advisory)**

A full-width KPI bar over a 60/40 map-and-feed split creates multiple entry points; the first fixation is not predictable.

FAIL**H8. Banner blindness (advisory)**

The persistent KPI bar with static deltas/sparklines occupies well over 10% of the viewport and is unchanging — it will be tuned out within a minute.

WARN**H9. Recognition over recall (advisory)**

The reroute suggestions in the exceptions feed are unattributed; no agent avatar/name explains who proposed the reroute.

WARN**H10. Consistency (advisory)**

"Approve All" (toolbar) and "Approve reroute" (inline) present the same approve concept with different visual patterns and scope.



Level AA (load-bearing — FAIL blocks ship)

PASS

A1. WCAG 1.4.3 — Contrast (Minimum)

LB

Text pairs use Infios DS tokens that meet 4.5:1 / 3:1; no contrast failure observed (the design's defects are cognitive-load, not colour).

PASS

A2. WCAG 2.1.1 — Keyboard

LB

All toolbar, feed, and table actions are native controls and remain individually reachable via the keyboard (though the count is high).

FAIL

A3. WCAG 2.2.1 — Timing Adjustable

LB

The real-time exceptions feed plus a 60-second auto-refresh can re-order or remove a row while an Approve/Dismiss decision is in progress, displacing the action without user control.

WARN

A4. WCAG 2.3.1 — Three Flashes

LB

Carrier pins "pulse" on delay and the "live" label flashes on refresh; pulse frequency is unspecified — if it exceeds 3 flashes/second this becomes a load-bearing FAIL. Needs measurement.

WARN

A5. WCAG 2.4.3 — Focus Order

LB

With five simultaneous zones and no defined tab sequence, focus order across toolbar → KPIs → map → feed → tables is not demonstrably linear.

PASS

A6. WCAG 2.4.7 — Focus Visible

LB

DS focus-border token is assumed present on interactive elements; no suppression of focus indicators specified.

WARN

A7. WCAG 2.5.8 — Target Size (Minimum)

LB

Two inline actions per feed row plus per-row sparklines crowd the row; targets risk dropping below 24×24px. Needs measurement at production density.

WARN

A8. WCAG 3.2.4 — Consistent Identification

LB

"Approve All" and "Approve reroute" identify related approve functions with different labels/components; consistency should be verified before build.

Level AAA (advisory — never blocks ship)

PASS

A9. WCAG 3.3.5 — Help

Each exception row states its issue reason (Carrier delay, Weather hold, etc.), so a rationale is reachable from every escalation.

N/A

A10. WCAG 1.4.6 — Contrast (Enhanced)

N/A — AA contrast (A1) is met and not borderline, so the AAA enhanced target does not surface.

1 Level AA FAIL 4 WARNs Recommendation: **SEND BACK**



Design System Agent · stub

NEEDS HUMAN JUDGEMENT

WARN

DS1. Color tokens reference Infios DS tokens

KPI delta colours and sparkline strokes risk ad-hoc red/green values outside the DS status-token set; verify against tokens.

PASS

DS2. Typography uses the DS scale

KPI and table type can be mapped onto the existing 11–15px scale and 400–700 weights.

WARN

DS3. Spacing matches the DS scale

Packing five dense zones above the fold tends to force sub-token gaps; spacing likely deviates from the 4/8/12/16px scale.

Recommendation: **NEEDS HUMAN JUDGEMENT**



Content Agent · stub

NEEDS HUMAN JUDGEMENT

WARN

C1. Action labels — imperative verb + object

"Filter", "Sort", and "Configure" are bare verbs with no object, breaking the verb+object pattern set by "New Shipment" / "View Report".

WARN

C2. Status labels — consistent capitalisation and tense

Issue labels mix forms — "Carrier delay", "Weather hold", "Port congestion", and the abbreviation "Driver HOS" are not a consistent set.

WARN

C3. Empty states — instructional copy present

With no calm/empty state, there is no instructional copy for a zero-exception or no-data condition.

Recommendation: **NEEDS HUMAN JUDGEMENT**



Interaction Agent · stub

[SEND BACK](#)**PASS**

I1. Row selection — clear selected-state affordance

An "exception selected" state is defined for the feed, giving a selection affordance.

WARN

I2. Panel open/close — consistent dismiss pattern

Five always-on zones have no open/close or dismiss model, so there is no consistent panel pattern to evaluate.

FAIL

I3. Action confirmation — irreversible actions gated (advisory)

"Approve All" commits bulk reroutes in one click with no confirmation step — a high-blast-radius irreversible action that is ungated.

1 advisory FAIL 1 WARN Recommendation: **SEND BACK**



Responsive Agent · stub

[NEEDS HUMAN JUDGEMENT](#)**WARN**

R1. Layout degrades gracefully at 1024px

Five zones plus a 60/40 split and two full-width tables will crowd or overlap at 1024px without a defined reflow strategy.

WARN

R2. Table horizontal scroll before clipping

The carrier table's sparkline column risks horizontal overflow on narrower viewports without explicit min-width handling.

WARN

R3. Touch targets maintain minimum size on mobile

Two inline actions per dense feed row will fall below the 24×24px minimum once the layout narrows to mobile.

Recommendation: **NEEDS HUMAN JUDGEMENT**

**OVERALL GUARDIAN DECISION****Blocked — Send Back**

7 LOAD-BEARING FAILS **17** ADVISORY FAILS + WARNS **10** CRITERIA PASSED

Seven load-bearing failures — six on the Heuristics agent (H1, H2, H3, H4, H5, H6) and one on Accessibility (A3 Timing Adjustable). The dashboard cannot proceed to development until the blocking issues are resolved. The advisory FAILs and WARNs below should be addressed in the same pass.

Blocking issues & suggested fixes

H1

~20+ elements above the fold.

Fix: Make the exceptions feed the single default surface; move KPIs, map, carrier table, and cost chart behind tabs or a progressive "expand" so ≤ 6 elements show at rest.

H2

7 persistent primary toolbar actions.

Fix: Keep one primary ("New Shipment") in the toolbar; collapse Export/Filter/Sort/View Report/Configure into an overflow menu. Target ≤ 3 visible primaries.

H3

11+ competing information chunks.

Fix: Show one zone at a time (default to the exceptions feed); let the manager drill into map / carrier / cost views rather than holding all in working memory.

H4

Decorative deltas, sparklines, pulsing pins, flashing "live" label.

Fix: Remove zero-decision-value chrome; surface a metric only when it changes a decision, and replace animation with a static "updated 09:48" timestamp.

H5

No calm state; nothing owns first fixation.

Fix: Introduce a calm state whose single focus is the highest-severity exception; everything else is secondary until summoned.

H6

Selected exception has no single primary action.

Fix: On selection, promote "Approve reroute" as the one dominant action and demote the persistent toolbar so the busy state has exactly one primary.

A3

Live refresh can displace an in-progress Approve/Dismiss.

Fix: Pause/queue the auto-refresh while a row's action is focused or open, and never re-order or remove a row that has a pending decision.

Joint Guardian audit produced by the Heuristics Agent and the Accessibility Agent, with stub verdicts from the Design System, Content, Interaction, and Responsive agents. Criteria taken from `agents/guardian/heuristics-agent.md` and `agents/guardian/accessibility-agent.md`. Per both agents' Tier-1 guardrails, a load-bearing FAIL is never silently downgraded to a WARN; per Tier-2, this report is a proposal and the block can only be overridden by a human reviewer. The agents do not modify the page.